

ANN ARBOR ROWING CLUB

Operational Policy

Hot-Weather Rowing (Heat Index) Cutoff

Purpose

To establish clear, conservative, and consistently applied thresholds for modifying or canceling outdoor rowing and training sessions during extreme heat, using the “feels like” temperature (heat index).

Scope and definitions

- Applies to all AARC-organized outdoor sessions (coached practices and other club-led outdoor workouts) as well as individual use of AARC-owned boats.
- “Feels like” refers to the heat index value from a reputable weather source (e.g., NWS / major forecast apps).
- Thresholds should be evaluated at session start and re-checked if conditions change materially.

Reference (optional): [National Weather Service Heat Index information](#)

Rowers at increased risk and opt-out (no repercussions)

AARC recognizes that some participants are at increased risk for heat illness or air quality breathing issues.

- Participants at increased risk are encouraged to self-identify privately to the coach/captain in charge (no details required).
- Any participant may opt out or request modification due to heat or AQI concerns at any time.
- Leaders should treat disclosures respectfully and confidentially, sharing only what is necessary to support safe participation.
- When feasible, leaders should offer a reasonable alternative (e.g., indoor workout, reduced intensity/duration, or modified role).

When “feels like” > 90°F:

- Each rower must have a water bottle on hand (mandatory).
- Coaches should provide additional hydration breaks and adjust intensity as needed.

When “feels like” > 95°F:

- Consider moving the session indoors (erg / strength) and/or reducing intensity/duration.

When “feels like” ≥ 98°F:

- No outdoor workouts (cancel or move indoors).